comprehend. Your programs will become less complicated and not so intertwined. Simplifying small things, like syntax, can lead to simpler big things, like programs. Although it's not a panacea (it's possible to write incomprehensible garbage in CoffeeScript), learning CoffeeScript will help you to write better programs. It's time to get started, time to write some CoffeeScript.

1.2. Running CoffeeScript

One thing you need to get out of the way is to make sure you're ready to start experimenting with CoffeeScript. Assuming you already have CoffeeScript installed (if not, refer to the "About this book" section before this chapter), open a console or terminal, type the word `coffee`, and press Enter. You see a prompt:

```
coffee>
```

You're now in the CoffeeScript REPL (pronounced like *ripple* but with an *e* instead of an *i*). Now enter some CoffeeScript and press Enter again:

```
coffee> 'CoffeeScript!'
'CoffeeScript!'
```

That's it, you've written CoffeeScript. To exit the REPL, press Ctrl-D (that's the Ctrl and D keys pressed simultaneously), and you'll be back to your regular command line. Why is it called a REPL? It stands for *Read-Eval-Print Loop*, and that's exactly what it does:

```
coffee> 'CoffeeScript!'  # Read 'CoffeeScript!'
                         # Evaluate 'CoffeeScript!'
'CoffeeScript!'          # Print the evaluation of 'CoffeeScript!'
coffee>                  # Loop (to start again)
```

By default, the CoffeeScript REPL will read only one line at a time before evaluating. In some cases you might want to evaluate two lines at a time. To do this, press Ctrl-V, and you'll see the prompt change. Now, regardless of how many times you press Enter, the REPL will continue to read until you